003-07 THE TRAM BOYCOTT OF 1912–1913 /1912-1913年的电车抵制运动

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The Tram <英>有轨电车 Boycott 电车抵制 of 1912–1913 showed /how dramatically 显著地；剧烈地 主 the political changes in revolutionary China 谓 could affect Hong Kong.

In April 1912, the Hong Kong government banned 禁止；取缔 the circulation 流通；传播 of Chinese coins.

The economies of Canton and Hong Kong had been intertwined (a.)缠绕的；紧密相连的；交织的 since the early days of the colony, and *Chinese coins* had been used in Hong Kong since then.

As conditions in Guangdong deteriorated 恶化；变坏 after the 1911 revolution, however, the colonial government became worried about the effects of an influx 大量涌入；流入 of depreciated 贬值的 Chinese coins from Guangdong.

Many Chinese in Hong Kong **took** the ban **as** an insult 侮辱；冒犯 to the new Chinese republic 共和国.

In November of the same year, Governor May encouraged *the Star Ferry 摆渡，渡运；空运 Company* and the colony's two tramways 电车系统；有轨电车线路 to stop (v.) accepting Chinese coins.

This caused (v.) even more resentment 愤恨；不满 among the Chinese population /because 主 the shortage 不足；短缺 of Hong Kong coinage （某种）硬币;货币 **in comparison 比较；对比 to** Chinese 谓 **left** (v.) local residents 居民 **with** less money for their tram fare 车费；票价.

这在中国民众中激起了更多的不满，因为与中国内地相比，香港硬币的短缺，使得当地居民用于支付电车费的钱更少了。

When a colony-wide 全殖民地范围的 boycott **broke out**, its organizers used (v.) various means to intimidate 恐吓；威胁 those who violated the boycott.

Example 1. 案例

The Tram Boycott of 1912–1913 showed how dramatically the political changes in revolutionary China could affect Hong Kong.
In April 1912, the Hong Kong government banned the circulation of Chinese coins.
The economies of Canton and Hong Kong had been intertwined since the early days of the colony, and Chinese coins had been used in Hong Kong since then.
As conditions in Guangdong deteriorated after the 1911 revolution, however, the colonial government became worried about the effects of an influx of depreciated Chinese coins from Guangdong.
Many Chinese in Hong Kong took the ban as an insult to the new Chinese republic.
In November of the same year, Governor May encouraged the Star Ferry Company and the colony's two tramways to stop accepting Chinese coins.
This caused even more resentment among the Chinese population because the shortage of Hong Kong coinage in comparison to Chinese left local residents with less money for their tram fare.
When a colony-wide boycott broke out, its organizers used various means to intimidate those who violated the boycott.

1912-1913年的电车抵制运动展现了革命时期中国的政治变革对香港产生的巨大影响。1912年4月, 香港政府禁止流通中国硬币。自香港建国初期, 广州和香港的经济就紧密相连, 香港也一直使用中国硬币。然而, 随着1911年辛亥革命后广东局势的恶化, 殖民政府开始担忧大量贬值的中国硬币从广东涌入香港会带来不利影响。许多香港华人将这项禁令视为对新成立的中华民国的侮辱。同年11月, 梅总督鼓励天星小轮公司和香港的两条电车线路停止接受中国硬币。这进一步激起了华人民众的不满, 因为香港硬币的短缺导致当地居民支付电车车费的钱财减少。当全港范围内的抵制运动爆发时, 组织者采取了各种手段恐吓违反抵制的人。

In December 1912, May encouraged prominent Chinese to help end (v.) the boycott.

He insisted that 主 the tram 有轨电车 companies' decision 后定说明 not to accept Chinese currency 货币 系 ① **was** purely an economic ② **and was not** intended to insult (v.)侮辱；冒犯 China /and that 主 the boycott 谓 would only hurt (v.) both Hong Kong and China /since 因为，由于 so much Chinese capital **was invested in** the tram companies.

他坚称，电车公司不接受人民币的决定, 纯粹是一项经济举措，并非有意侮辱中国，而且由于有大量中国资本投入电车公司，抵制行动只会对香港和中国都造成伤害。

On December 20, during a meeting at *the Chinese Commercial 商业的；营利的 Union*, 主 Ho Kai and Wei Yuk, both unofficial Legislative Council members, 谓 defended 维护；辩护 the tram companies and condemned 谴责；指责 the boycott for harming the economies of both Hong Kong and Guangdong.

A weakened 被削弱的 Hong Kong economy, they argued, would mean that /Hong Kong residents 居民 would have less money to help their kin 亲属；家人 in Guangdong.

With help from local Chinese merchants, the boycott ended (v.) by early February 1913.

Although 主 several of the Chinese who collaborated 合作；协作 with the government to end (v.) the boycott 谓 received threatening 威胁的 letters, May was disappointed by *the lack of influence* 后定说明 that 主 the more prominent Chinese 谓 now **seemed to have** 似乎拥有 over 对…的 (控制或影响力) the Chinese population 对华人群体.

尽管几个中国人 (该中国人是与政府合作结束抵制的) 收到了威胁信，梅对影响力的缺乏 (该影响力是那些更显赫的中国人,现在表面上似乎对华人群体拥有的) 感到失望。

Example 2. 案例
May was disappointed by the lack of influence /that the more prominent Chinese now seemed to have over the Chinese population.

但 May 对"华人领袖如今似乎已丧失对华人群体影响力"的现状, 感到失望。

seemed to have：**seem表示“似乎、看起来”，暗示这种影响力是表面的、不可靠的，或者已经减弱了。**

He was particularly annoyed 恼怒的；生气的 that /Ho Kai and Wei Yuk **had waited so long** to help end the boycott.

Indeed, 主 Ho’s failure to help the government earlier 系 was part of the reason he **was not reappointed (v.)重新任命 to** a fifth term 任期 on the Legislative Council.

Ho Kai 和 Wei Yuk 拖延了这么久才帮忙结束抵制活动，这让他尤为恼火。 事实上，Ho 未能早些协助政府，这也是他未能获得"立法局第五任连任"的部分原因。

Nevertheless 然而；尽管如此, the defeat 失败；挫败 of the boycott 谓 boosted (v.)增强；提高 the government’s authority 权威；权力.

Example 3. 案例

In December 1912, May encouraged prominent Chinese to help end the boycott.
He insisted that the tram companies’ decision not to accept Chinese currency was purely an economic move and was not intended to insult China and that the boycott would only hurt both Hong Kong and China since so much Chinese capital was invested in the tram companies.
On December 20, during a meeting at the Chinese Commercial Union, Ho Kai and Wei Yuk, both unofficial Legislative Council members, defended the tram companies and condemned the boycott for harming the economies of both Hong Kong and Guangdong.
A weakened Hong Kong economy, they argued, would mean that Hong Kong residents would have less money to help their kin in Guangdong.
With help from local Chinese merchants, the boycott ended by early February 1913.
Although several of the Chinese who collaborated with the government to end the boycott received threatening letters, May was disappointed by the lack of influence that the more prominent Chinese now seemed to have over the Chinese population.
He was particularly annoyed that Ho Kai and Wei Yuk had waited so long to help end the boycott.
Indeed, Ho’s failure to help the government earlier was part of the reason he was not reappointed to a fifth term on the Legislative Council.
Nevertheless, the defeat of the boycott boosted the government’s authority. 1912年12月, 梅鼓励一些华人名流协助结束抵制活动。他坚称, 电车公司拒绝接受人民币纯粹是出于经济考量, 并非意在侮辱中国, 而且由于大量中国资本投资于电车公司, 抵制只会损害香港和中国。12月20日, 在中华商会的一次会议上, 何佳和魏玉两位立法会非官方议员为电车公司辩护, 并谴责抵制活动损害了香港和广东的经济。他们认为, 香港经济疲软意味着香港居民将无力资助在广东的亲属。在当地华人商人的帮助下, 抵制活动于1913年2月初结束。尽管一些与政府合作结束抵制活动的华人收到了恐吓信, 但梅对华人名流如今似乎对华人民众缺乏影响力感到失望。他尤其恼火何恺明和魏玉迟迟不肯出手相助结束抵制运动。事实上, 何恺明未能早些协助政府, 正是他未能连任立法会议员第五届的原因之一。尽管如此, 抵制运动的失败还是提升了政府的权威。